Learning to Trust Again

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Manuscript excerpt

“Learning to Trust Again”
Subtitle: When Anxiety Meets the Faithfulness of God

“Anxiety isn’t always a lack of faith…
sometimes it’s the scar tissue of broken trust.”

“Some of us aren’t struggling because we don’t believe in God…
we’re struggling because life taught us to brace for impact.”

PRIMARY TEXT — TRUST VS ANXIETY

Matthew 6:25–26

“Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on. Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?
Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?”

Matthew 6:31–32

“Therefore take no thought, saying, What shall we eat? or, What shall we drink? or, Wherewithal shall we be clothed?
(For after all these things do the Gentiles seek:) for your heavenly Father knoweth that ye have need of all these things.”

Matthew 6:33–34

“But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.
Take therefore no thought for the morrow: for the morrow shall take thought for the things of itself…”

BIRDS — GOD’S DAILY PROVISION

Luke 12:24

“Consider the ravens: for they neither sow nor reap; which neither have storehouse nor barn; and God feedeth them: how much more are ye better than the fowls?”

BEASTS — GOD’S SUSTAINING POWER

Psalm 147:9

“He giveth to the beast his food, and to the young ravens which cry.”

Psalm 104:27–28

“These wait all upon thee; that thou mayest give them their meat in due season.
That thou givest them they gather: thou openest thine hand, they are filled with good.”

Psalm 50:10–11

“For every beast of the forest is mine, and the cattle upon a thousand hills.
I know all the fowls of the mountains: and the wild beasts of the field are mine.”

Job 38:39–41

“Wilt thou hunt the prey for the lion? or fill the appetite of the young lions,
When they couch in their dens…
Who provideth for the raven his food? when his young ones cry unto God…”

POINT 1 — THE SCALE OF GOD’S PROVISION

Paint the picture:

“There are roughly 50 billion birds on this earth…
and not one of them has a job, a savings account, or a backup plan.”

“And God feeds them. Every day.”

Now widen it:

“Not just birds—beasts of the field…
lions, deer, creatures in deserts, oceans, forests…”

Line:
“God doesn’t just feed birds—He sustains entire ecosystems.”

Drive it home:
“Nothing in creation is anxious…
yet nothing in creation is forgotten.”

POINT 2 — THE REAL PROBLEM ISN’T PROVISION… IT’S TRUST

Good. Let’s anchor this in pure Scripture so nobody can argue with the foundation. I’ll give you clean, in-line references you can read or quote directly—KJV style for preaching flow.

THE HUMAN STRUGGLE — ANXIOUS HEART

Proverbs 12:25

“Heaviness in the heart of man maketh it stoop: but a good word maketh it glad.”

Philippians 4:6–7

“Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God.
And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.”

1 Peter 5:7

“Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.”

Shift tone—get real.

“Jesus didn’t point to birds because we lack resources…
He pointed to birds because we lack trust.”

Line:
“Anxiety is not a supply problem—it’s a trust problem.”

But then pivot (this is where your message becomes different):

“Now let me be honest…
some of you don’t struggle with trust because you’re faithless—
you struggle because you’ve been hurt.”

POINT 3 — WHEN TRUST HAS BEEN WOUNDED

This is your moment—slow down here.

“You weren’t always this guarded…
life taught you that.”